

State of the Web 2020–2025

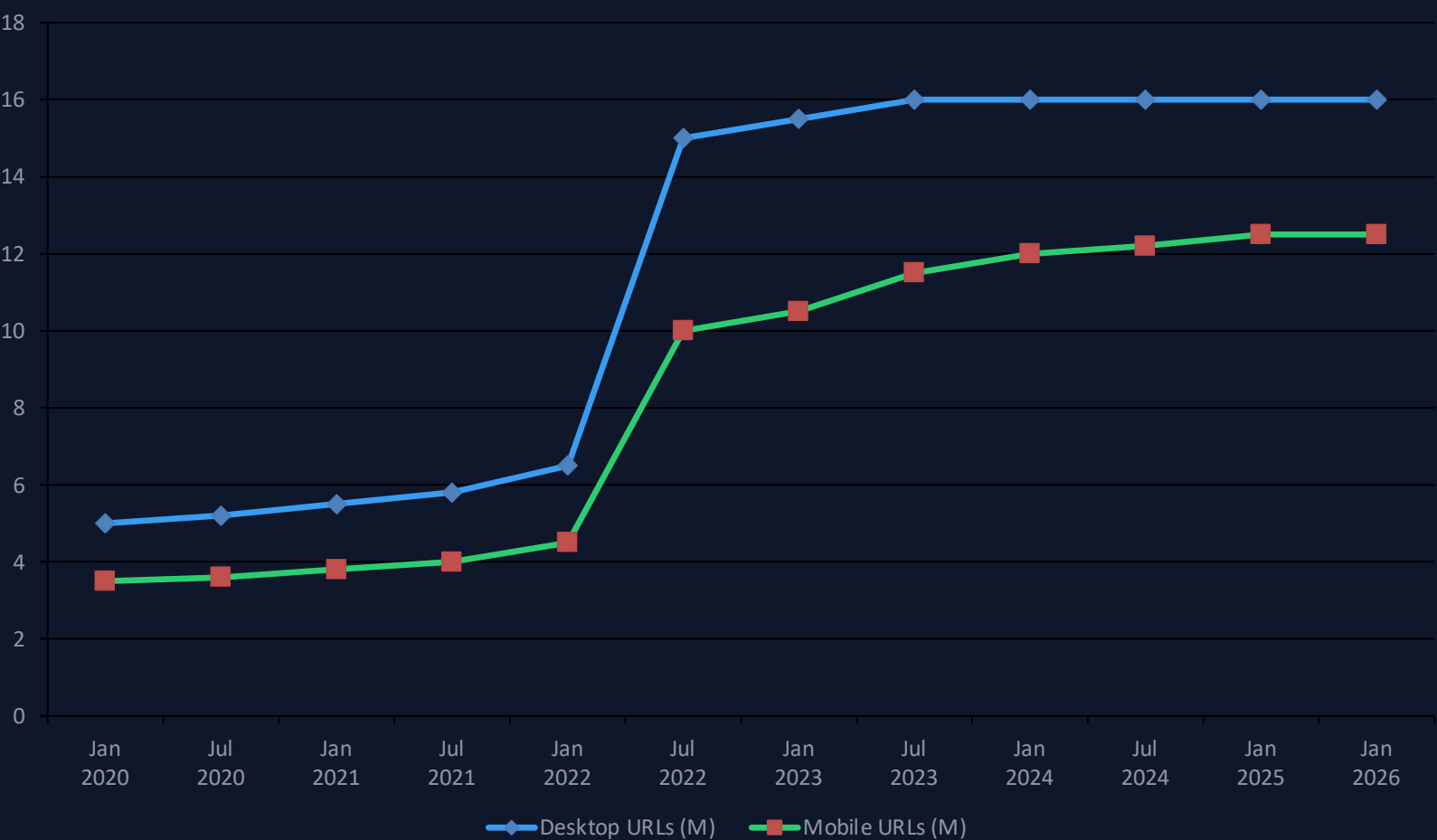
HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

Data Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Time Range: January 2020 – March 2026 | Desktop & Mobile

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive's crawl scope expanded dramatically in mid-2022, then plateaued near 16M desktop / 12.5M mobile URLs.



Key Milestones

Desktop Jan 2020

~5M URLs

Desktop Jan 2026

16M URLs

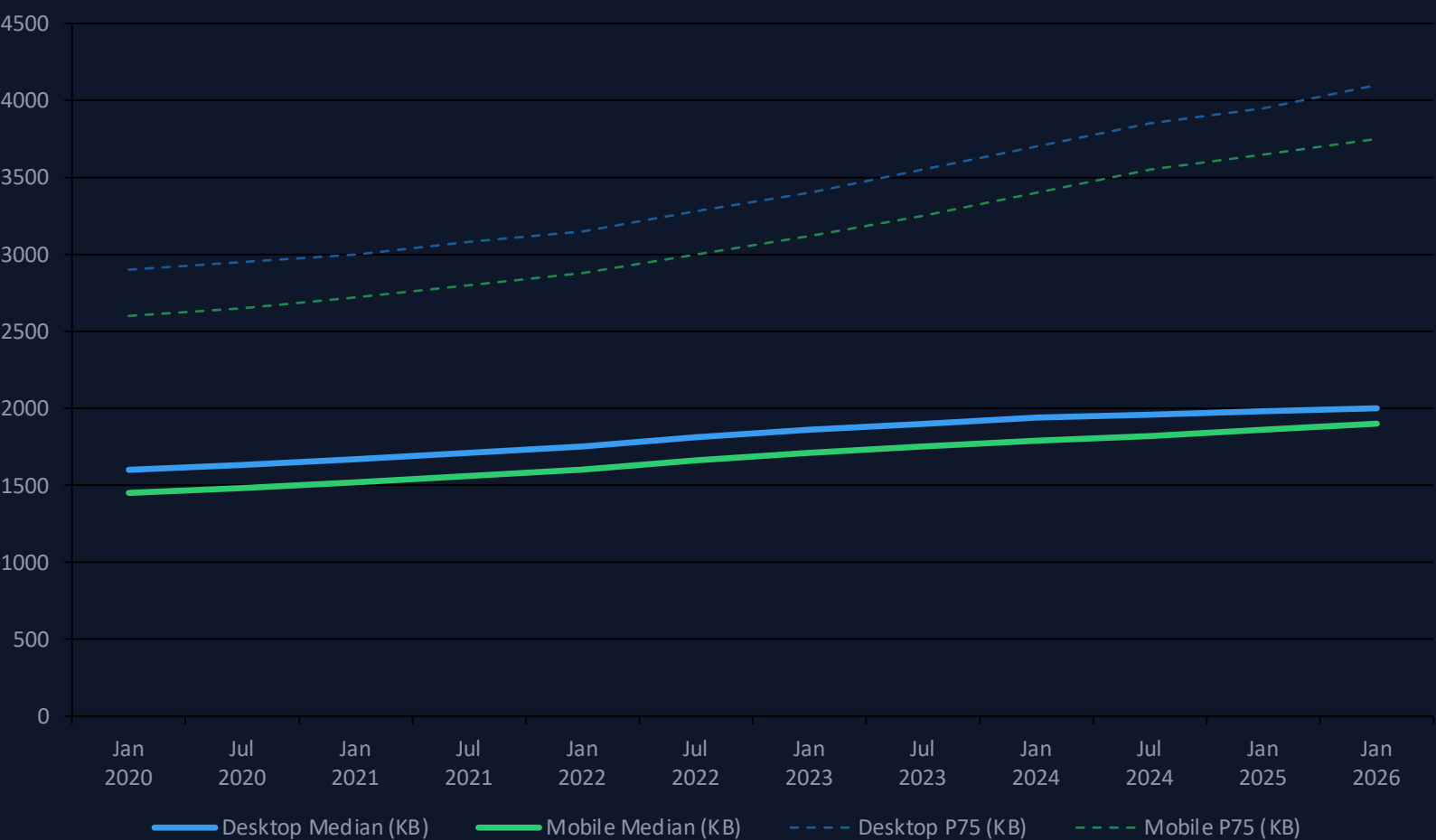
Mobile Jan 2026

12.5M URLs

Sharp jump in mid-2022 when crawl methodology expanded

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Desktop median transfer size rose ~25% from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB. The 75th-percentile page exceeds 4,000 KB.



Weight Snapshot

Desktop Median

~2,000 KB

Mobile Median

~1,900 KB

Desktop 75th Pctl

> 4,000 KB

Both platforms up ~25% since 2020

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More resources per page, yet fewer TCP connections — multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 drives the efficiency gain.

Total Requests per Page (Median)

DESKTOP

76

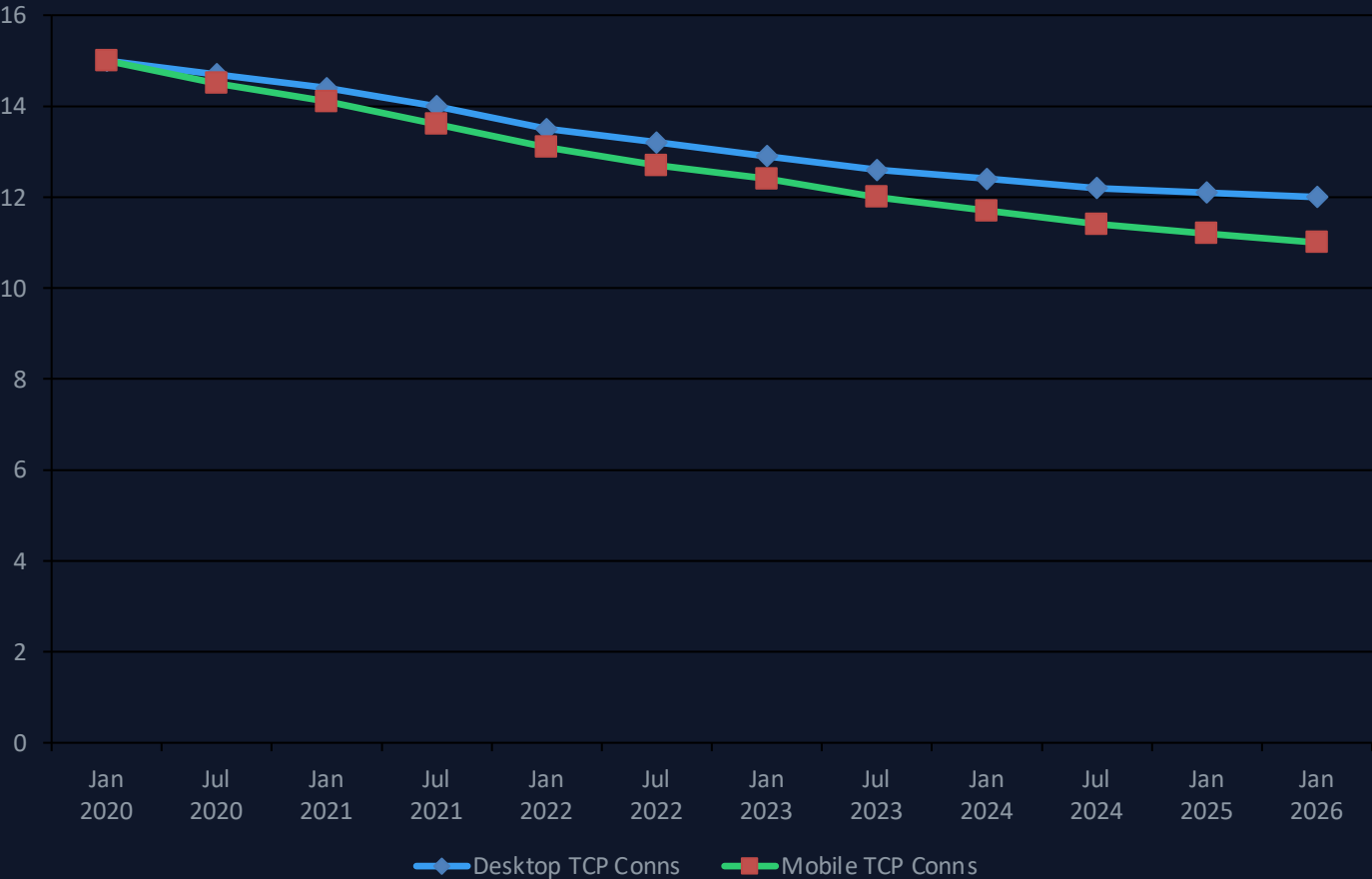
▲ 2.7% since 2020

MOBILE

71

▲ 2.9% since 2020

TCP Connections per Page (Median) — Declining



Desktop ▼ 14.3% | Mobile ▼ 26.7% — Multiplexing cuts connections despite more requests

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

From ~80% in 2020 to 99%+ today — plaintext HTTP is effectively gone from the modern web.

HTTPS Adoption

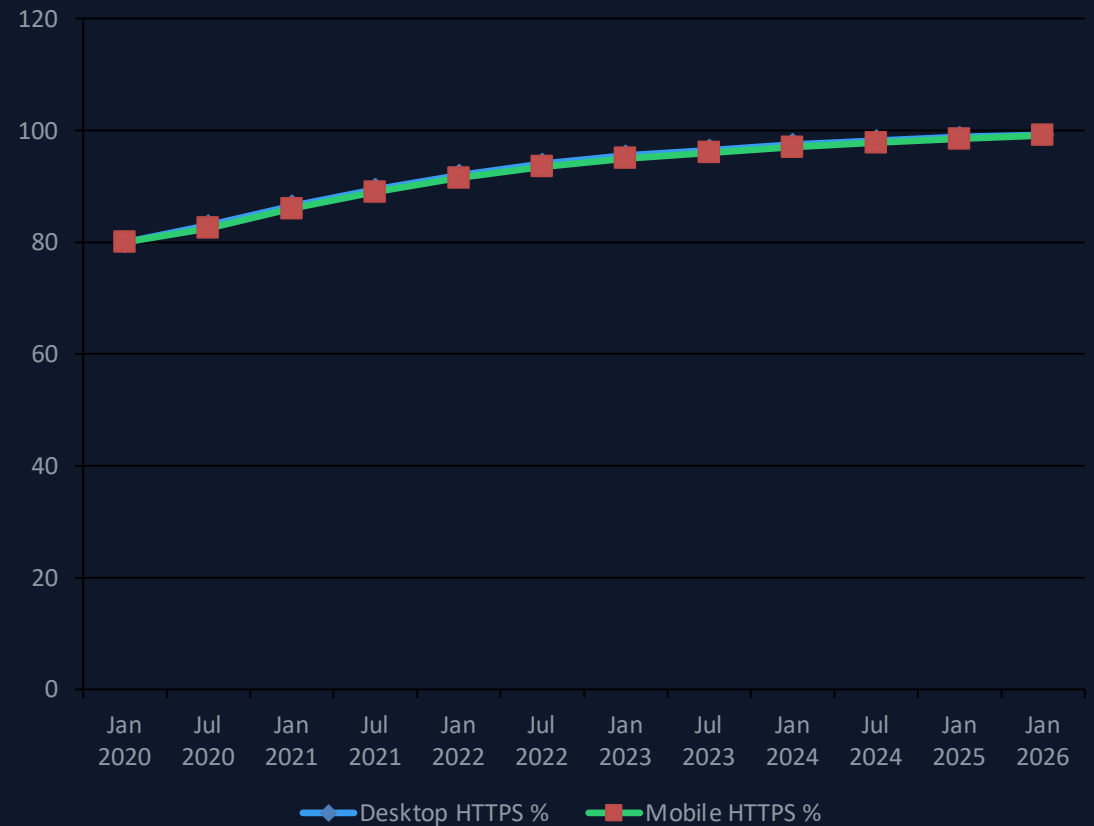
99%+

Desktop: 99.2% | Mobile: 99.1%

▲ ~19–20 pp since Jan 2020

Unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct

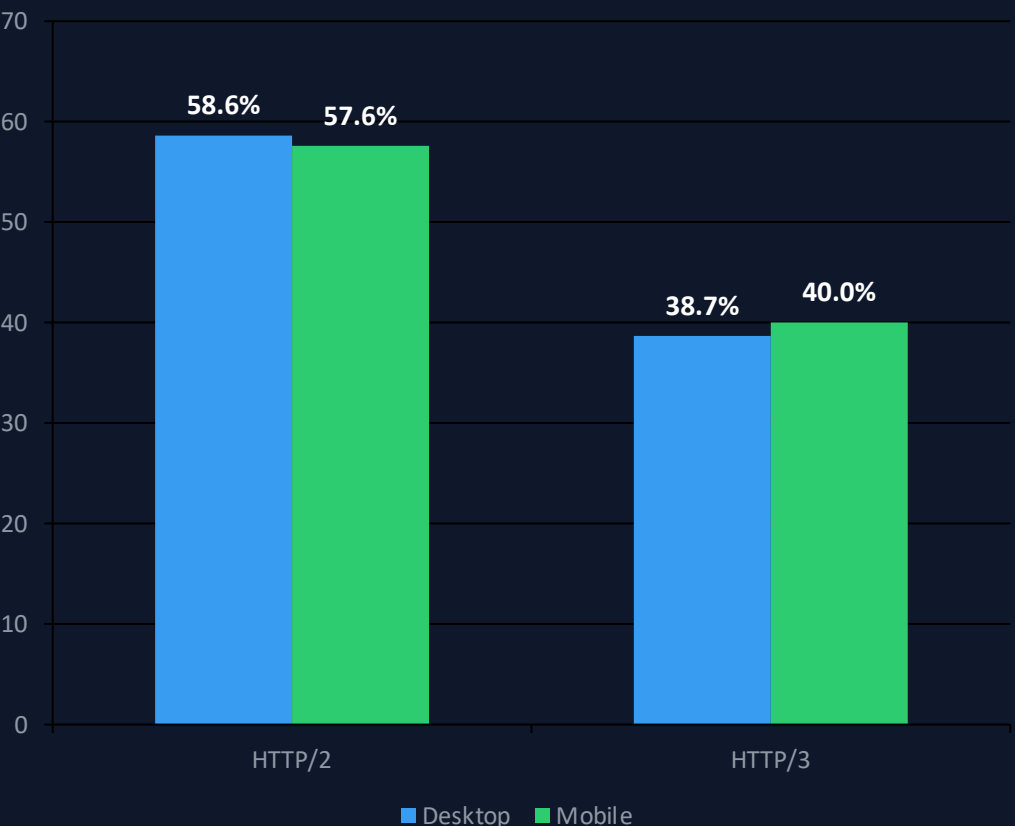
HTTPS Adoption Over Time (%)



HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/2 growth has flattened as HTTP/3 absorbs new adoption. HTTP/3 support has exploded from near-zero to ~40%.

Current Protocol Share (%)

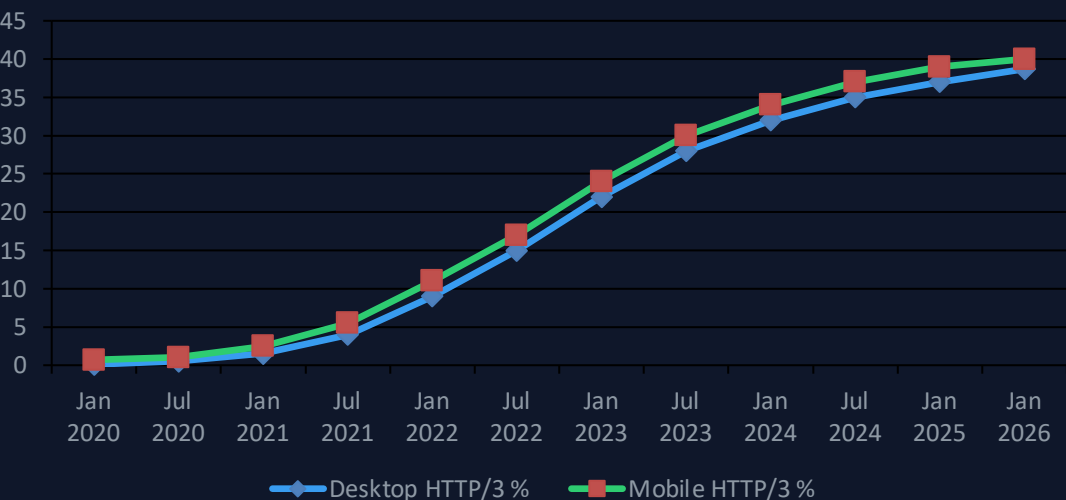


HTTP/3 Growth

Desktop: 38.7% | Mobile: 40.0%

From near-zero in 2020 — reported as 38,600% desktop / 5,614% mobile growth

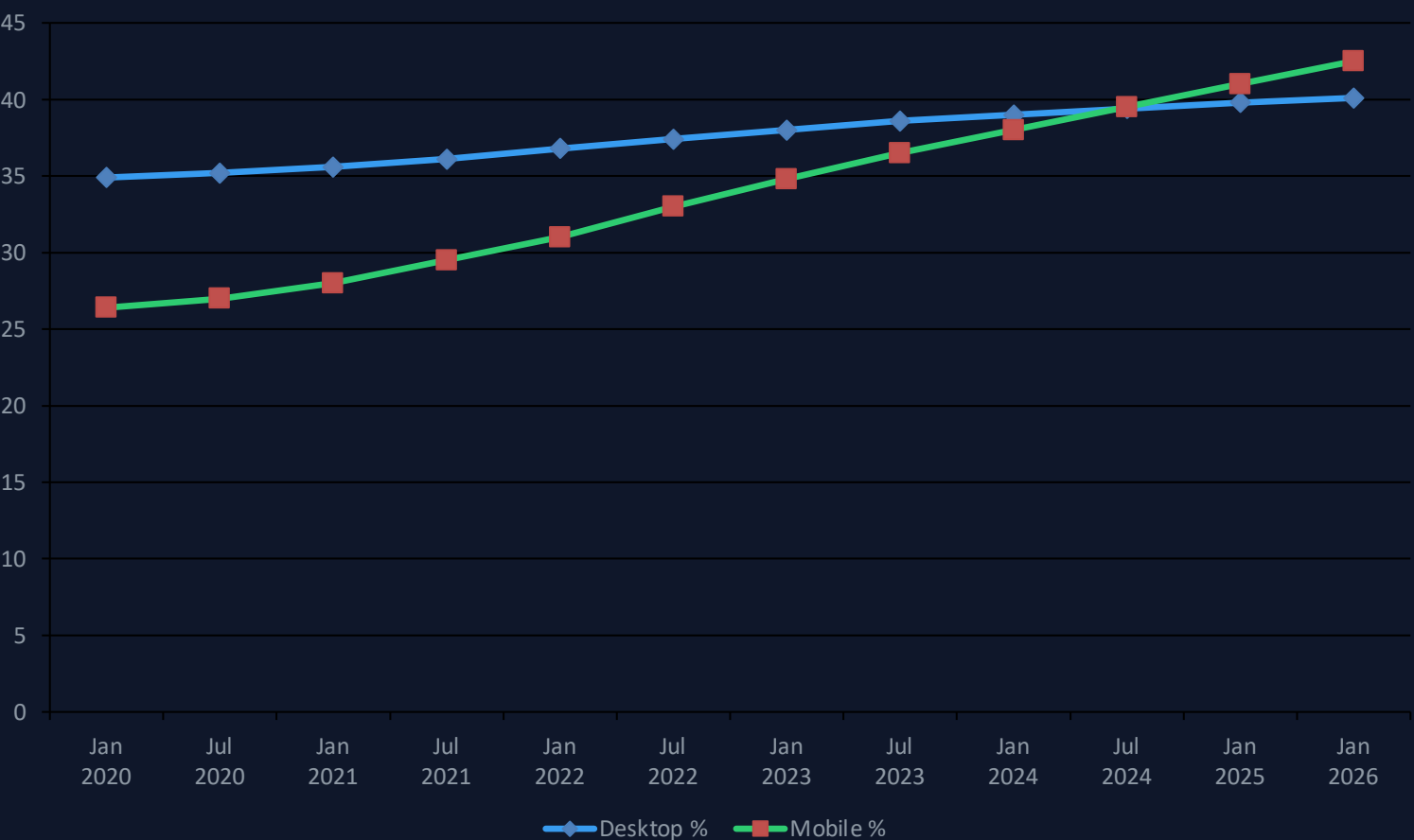
HTTP/3 Support Over Time (%)



Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (Alt-Svc discovery) rather than actual usage; fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

The font-display CSS property avoids Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) — but more than half of pages still don't use it.



Font-Display Stats

Desktop Adoption

40.1%

▲ 14.9% since 2020

Mobile Adoption

42.5%

▲ 61.0% since 2020

> 50% of pages still risk FOIT — significant room for improvement

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — roughly 25% heavier than 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

2

HTTPS is the new baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web.

3

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream.

4

Fewer TCP connections despite more requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%.

5

Font-display still underused

At ~40–42% adoption, there is significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading.

Call to Action

Benchmark your own sites against these HTTP Archive baselines.

Prioritize:

- Page weight audits
- HTTP/3 enablement
- Font-display adoption
- TLS configuration

httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web